

Modernism Week Trip Itinerary

Palm Springs design getaway | Prepared for Jessica Spencer

Traveler	Jessica Spencer
Dates	February 18 to February 22, 2027
Purpose	Mid century modern shows and home tours
Lodging	Mid century rental near the design district

Overview

A focused few days in Palm Springs for the mid century modern shows, home tours, and the vintage dealers. The trip doubles as inspiration for the studio and a sourcing run for the casita and for client projects. The plan keeps mornings for tours and shooting, afternoons for dealers, and evenings easy.

Daily Plan

Thursday, February 18. Afternoon flight, check in at the rental, settle the camera kit and chargers. Evening walk through the design district, a light dinner, and an early night before the tours begin.

Friday, February 19. Modern home tour in the morning while the light is good, notes and photographs of details worth bringing home. Vintage dealer browsing in the afternoon, with a short list of pieces to watch. Quiet dinner and a review of the day finds.

Saturday, February 20. Design lectures and the show floor for most of the day, the heart of the trip. Dinner with the collector group in the evening to compare finds and trade leads on dealers.

Sunday, February 21. Architecture photography in the morning with the 35mm prime, the calm hour before the crowds. A leisurely afternoon, one more pass at a favorite dealer, and packing the finds for shipping.

Monday, February 22. Final dealer stops near the rental, a midday flight home, and a list of follow ups for the studio while the trip is fresh.

Lodging and Logistics

A mid century rental near the design district keeps everything within a short drive and fits the spirit of the week. Rental car for the home tours and dealer runs. Keep the schedule loose enough to chase a good tour or a dealer tip without stress.

Photography Plan

Pack the 35mm prime and extra cards for shooting, plus a spare battery and the charger. Shoot the architecture early and late for the warm light, and capture material and detail shots for the studio reference library and the mood board wall. Back up the cards each evening.

Shopping and Sourcing Targets

Keep an eye out for vintage lounge seating for the casita and a piece or two for client projects, the kind of find that makes a room. Trade budget for finds is confirmed separately, and anything at or above 500 gets the usual sign off before it is committed. Note dealer contacts and shipping options for anything

too large to carry.

Packing List

Camera kit and 35mm prime, cards, batteries, and charger. Comfortable shoes for the tours, a light layer for cool desert evenings, and a notebook for the lectures. A soft roll for protecting small finds in the luggage, and labels for anything shipped home.

Getting Around

A rental car covers the home tours and the dealer runs, which are spread across the valley. Build in a little buffer between tour times, since parking near the popular homes fills early. Keep a paper map of the tour stops as a backup, and group the dealer visits by neighborhood to save the driving.

Weather and Timing

February in the desert is mild by day and cool after dark, so a light layer for the evenings is worth packing. The morning light is the reason to start early for both the tours and the photography, and the afternoons stay comfortable for browsing on foot.

Trip Goals for the Studio

Bring back a fresh read on what the best rooms are doing this year, a folder of detail shots for the mood board wall, and two or three dealer relationships worth keeping. Watch for a statement lounge chair or a small case piece that could anchor an upcoming client room, and note anything that would photograph well for the portfolio.

Dining and Evenings

Keep dinners simple and early most nights to stay sharp for the morning tours. Hold Saturday evening for the collector group, a standing tradition that is half social and half sourcing. A quiet last night before the Monday flight, with the finds packed and labeled.

Reservations to Hold

Confirm the rental and the car ahead of the week, since both book up fast during the shows. Hold the Saturday dinner with the collector group, and keep a flexible reservation or two for the nights that the tours run long. A standing early breakfast near the rental keeps the mornings simple.

What a Good Trip Looks Like

A trip is a success if it comes home with sharper ideas than it left with, a handful of detail shots worth pinning to the mood board wall, one or two finds that earn their place in the casita or a client room, and a couple of dealer relationships worth keeping warm through the year. Inspiration first, sourcing second, and rest somewhere in between.

Notes and Follow Ups

Send thank you notes to any dealer who held a piece, log the trip expenses for the bookkeeper, and add the strongest references to the studio library while the week is fresh. Schedule a short team debrief so the ideas land on current projects rather than fading after the trip.

Budget Notes

Travel and lodging are tracked under studio travel and trade shows. Finds for the casita are personal, finds for client projects are billed to the relevant project at trade pricing. Hold receipts for the bookkeeper, and flag any single purchase at or above 500 before committing.